FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-21008

Issue Title : Unexpected DATALINK FULL Message with Flight Management Computer (FMC) with U14 Software.

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3400-00	-10, -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
737NG	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
12/22/2021	09/18/2026	11/13/2024
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
03/29/2028	12/19/2026	

Revision Description

Updated U14.2 Target Release timeline to change to 1Q2028

Applicability

Applies to 737 MAX airplanes.

Description

737 Operators with FMC U14 software have reported unexpected display of the DATALINK FULL message on the Control Display Unit (CDU) PERF INIT page while using the Airline Operational Control (AOC) flex prompts (for clarity, see attached presentation page 1 of 2) and/or the data requested via downlink is not being uplinked. Under normal conditions, when the DATALINK FULL is message is displayed at the AOC flex prompts, this indicates that the downlink queue is full and the FMC is incapable of sending additional downlink messages until the queue has been cleared.

In this specific case, because of a software change created by the U14 version, a coding issue prevents the FMC generated downlink messages from being provided to the CMU and therefore the data is not downlinked / sent from the aircraft. Further, when this issue is encountered, all the downlink messages generated either by CDU line selection or in response to uplinks (such as position requests), are added to the downlink queue, instead of being downlinked from the aircraft. When the downlink queue reaches its full capacity (approximately 15 messages), the DATALINK FULL message is displayed at all AOC flex prompts and further downlink messages are prevented from being initiated via the CDU.

This issues related to dual FMC functionality and will most likely be encountered upon FMC and CMU power-up. Additionally, it is important to note, that when this issue is encountered, downlinks may also be prevented from reaching the ground prior to the display of DATALINK FULL. Since this message is displayed only when the downlink queue is at capacity, downlinks generated prior to the queue becoming full will also not have been downlinked to the ground.

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Be aware that this issue can be identified prior to the display of the DATALINK FULL at the AOC flex prompts - If a downlink is initiated via AOC flex prompt (such as Report or Request) and the caret (either < or >) on that flex prompt does not return within 5 seconds, then the downlink was not sent successfully. Repeated attempts to initiate further downlink messages will eventually result in the display of DATALINK FULL and the Interim Action below needs to be taken.

Status

Boeing and the 737 FMC software supplier GE, have reproduced the issue and determined a root cause. A fix is planned to be incorporated into upcoming software Blockpoint U14.2.

Interim Action

To clear the DATALINK FULL stuck condition (refer to the attached presentation page 1 of 2), the maintainer or Flight Crew will lbe required to change the FMC source select switch to “Both on R” for up to 30 to 40 seconds and then back to “Normal”. At this point, the downlink messages “stuck” in the queue should begin downlinking normally and further downlink messages can be initiated.

Alternatively, resetting the FMCs by cycling power to both FMCs will also clear the downlink queue. However, operators should only reset the FMCs while on the ground and only after the symptoms occur.

Final Action

Incorporate FMS OPS U14.2 Service Bulletins when released.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: November 2021.

Solution Selected: November 2021.

Change Committed: FMC U14.2

Target MAX SB Release: 1Q2028

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability

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- Dispatch Reliability Issues : Issues that cause revenue flight delays and cancellations
- Flight Deck Effects and Maintenance Messages : Issue that occurs frequently and causes a flight deck effect or maintenance message
- Flight Operations : Flight Operations

Attachments:

a) FMC U14 Unexpected DATALINK FULL

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